PROMISES TO KEEP

HOW THE BJP'S *SANKALP PATRA* MEASURES UP AGAINST THE CONGRESS'S *NYAY PATRA*

Compiled by **Anilesh S. Mahajan**



BJP'S SANKALP

CHANDRADEEP KUMAR

MODI KI GUARANTEE—that's what the Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) has titled its *Sankalp Patra*, or election manifesto, as it seeks a third successive term at the Centre. In doing so, the party has distinctively moved away from its oft-cited convention of collective leadership, centring its entire campaign on its biggest trump card: Prime Minister Narendra Modi. The manifesto is peppered with core Hindutva issues like the implementation of the Citizenship Amendment Act and Uniform Civil Code, major reforms like the 'One Nation, One Election', and big-ticket crowd-pleasers like bullet trains. Yet, overarching this array of proposals is a commitment to continue with the "transformative growth" of four core groups—*gareeb* (poor), *yuva* (youth), *annadata* (farmers) and *nari* (women). In contrast, the Congress manifesto, titled *Nyay Patra*, centres on five fundamental pillars: justice for youth, women, farmers, labourers and equitable resource distribution among marginalised sections. So, a nationwide caste census is among its promises, as is a constitutional amendment to raise the 50 per cent cap on reservations for SCs, STs and OBCs. What follows is a comparison of their key guarantees.

WOMEN

- Transform 30 million rural women into 'Lakhpati Didis' by empowering women SHGs (self-help groups)
- Systematically implement 33 per cent reservation for women in national and state legislatures
- Expand existing health services for prevention of anaemia, breast and cervical cancer

- Reserve 50 per cent central jobs for women
- Implement women's reservation in state legislatures from 2025
- Double the number of working women hostels, open enough night shelters for migrant women



FARMERS

- Provide better support through higher minimum support price (MSP) for major crops and crop diversification incentives
- Integrated planning and implementation of agri-infrastructure projects like storage facilities, irrigation, food processing, etc.

- A legal guarantee to the MSP in line with the Swaminathan Commission's recommendations
- A permanent commission on agricultural finance to monitor farm credit and address loan-related issues



POOR

- Continue to provide free ration to 800 million-plus citizens under PM Garib Kalyan Anna Yojana
- Expand the existing schemes for quality housing, potable water and cooking fuel to millions of poor beneficiaries

- Mahalakshmi, a scheme offering Rs 1 lakh yearly to the oldest woman/ member of a poor family
- A national minimum wage of Rs 400 per day, including under MGNREGA